

Calcium chloride

I. Classification

- Electrolyte

II. Action(s)

- An essential component for proper function of nervous and muscular systems, normal cardiac contractility, and coagulation of blood

III. Indication(s)

- Hyperkalemia
- Calcium Channel or Beta Blocker toxicity

IV. Contraindications

- V-fib during cardiac resuscitation
- Digitalis toxicity
- Hypercalcemia

V. Precautions

- Flush IV line between administration of calcium chloride and sodium bicarbonate
- Very irritating to soft tissues if extravasation occurs

VI. Drug interactions

- Digitalis – asystole, worsen arrhythmias

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 1000 mg of 10% solution, slow IV/IO
- Administer no faster than 100 mg / min (1 ml/min)

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- 20 mg/kg of 10% solution, slow IV/IO – Max dose 1000 mg
- Administer no faster than 100 mg / min (1 ml / min)

IX. Onset

- 5-15 minutes

X. Duration

- 30 – 90 minutes

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Nausea
- Bradycardia (with rapid administration)
- Hypotension (with rapid administration)

XII. Other Notes

- Avoid giving in the pre-hospital environment if patient takes digoxin